Northwind Labs Engineering Handbook

Git Workflow

Northwind engineering uses trunk-based development. Branches are short-lived and should be merged into main within 2 days.

Branch names follow the pattern type/short-description, for example feat/login-page or fix/payment-timeout.

Every pull request needs 2 approving reviews and a passing CI build before it can be merged. Pull requests are merged using squash merge to keep the main branch history clean.

Deployments

All services are built and tested by GitHub Actions. Every merge to main is deployed automatically to the staging environment.

Production deployments happen on Tuesdays and Thursdays between 11:00 and 15:00 IST. There are no production deployments on Fridays or the day before a public holiday.

Every deployment must have a rollback plan. If error rates rise above 2 percent after a release, the on-call engineer rolls back first and investigates afterwards.

On-Call and Incidents

Engineers join a weekly on-call rotation after completing 3 months at the company. The rotation hands over every Monday at 10:00 IST.

A Sev1 incident (customer-facing outage) must be acknowledged within 15 minutes. A Sev2 incident must be acknowledged within 1 hour.

Every Sev1 and Sev2 incident needs a blameless postmortem document within 5 business days, with action items assigned to owners.